



Comprehensive Schedule Validation Checklist

(Based on DCMA 14-Point Assessment for EPC Projects)

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Standard: Defense Contract Management Agency (DCMA) & AACE International

Purpose: To ensure schedule integrity, logic accuracy, and realistic forecasting before baseline approval.

Site Address: <https://sbmousavices.github.io/Industrial-Tools/EnglishInfo.html>

Section 1: Logic & Relationships (The Backbone)

#	Check Item	Standard Threshold	Status (Pass/Fail)	Notes
1	Logic Completeness	All activities must have at least one predecessor and one successor (except Start/Finish milestones).	☐	
2	No Open Ends	Zero activities with missing links.	☐	
3	Valid Relationship Types	Use FS (Finish-to-Start) as the primary type. Minimize SS, FF, and SF.	☐	
4	Lag Usage	Avoid positive/negative lags unless technically justified. Max 5% of total relationships.	☐	

Section 2: Constraints & Float (The Flexibility)

#	Check Item	Standard Threshold	Status (Pass/Fail)	Notes
5	Hard Constraints	Minimize "Must Finish On" or "Start No Earlier Than". Use soft constraints only when necessary.	☐	
6	Total Float Distribution	Ensure float is distributed logically. Avoid excessive negative float without recovery plans.	☐	
7	Critical Path Validity	The critical path must be continuous and logical from start to finish.	☐	

✔ Section 3: Durations & Resources (The Reality)

#	Check Item	Standard Threshold	Status (Pass/Fail)	Notes
8	Realistic Durations	No activity should exceed 44 working days (2 months) without being broken down.	☐	
9	Resource Leveling	Check for over-allocations in manpower and equipment histograms.	☐	
10	High Float Activities	Investigate activities with Total Float > 6 months; they may indicate missing logic.	☐	

✔ Section 4: Progress & Updates (The Health)

#	Check Item	Standard Threshold	Status (Pass/Fail)	Notes
11	Out-of-Sequence Progress	Minimize OOS progress. If present, use "Progress Override" or "Retained Logic" consistently.	☐	
12	Actual Dates	Ensure actual start/finish dates are entered for completed activities.	☐	
13	Data Date Integrity	The data date must be current and consistent with the last status update.	☐	

✔ Section 5: Structural Quality (The Framework)

#	Check Item	Standard Threshold	Status (Pass/Fail)	Notes
14	WBS Alignment	Activities must be correctly coded under the WBS hierarchy.	☐	
15	Milestone Definition	Milestones must have zero duration and clear deliverables.	☐	

💡 Pro Tips from Behzad Mousavi:

- **Don't just check the boxes;** understand the "Why" behind each metric.
- **Use Automated Tools:** Manual checking is prone to error. Consider using our **WBS Grouping Tool** or **Primavera P6 Layouts** to visualize these metrics instantly.
- **Baseline Defense:** A schedule that passes this 14-point check is much harder for clients or contractors to reject during baseline negotiations.